

December 20, 1943
2:00 p.m.

Conversation between Mr. Riegelman of State and Mr. Fox.

- F. Since my conversation with you earlier today I have been informed of the facts of the situation and I feel that Treasury should have a look at the paraphrase of the cable before you come over to discuss it.
- R. But I have already delivered copies to the Secretary this morning. I delivered them myself.
- F. Well then, we should wait until we have seen it.
- R. I intend to bring a copy with me; I would rather you saw the original anyway; I tried my darndest to get the sense of the cable into the paraphrase but it is rather difficult; you will not want the license to be issued after seeing it.
- F. Since the matter is being handled through channels, we had better keep it in channels. After we see the cable, if we have any questions we will get in touch with State.
- R. I would still like to have an opportunity to discuss the matter with you personally from a perfectly objective point of view with a view to a complete clarification of the situation.
- F. We will read the cable and if we have any questions we will get in touch with State.
- R. Then in the meantime I will send off no message to the Embassy, and I presume the license will be issued.
- F. I am not sufficiently familiar with the matter to make any statement. It is being handled through other channels.
- R. Well, if that's the way you want it, so be it, but I would like to give you a little of the background so you will understand why I am so anxious to discuss this with you. Due to circumstances surrounding a telegram sent in August expressing Treasury approval of the Riegner plan.....the Secretary said the Treasury could act in any way that it saw fit. Since that time, as a result of this recent interchange of nasty letters, so to speak, he has removed this ban from us and is willing for us to talk to you and work out something